

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

ANNUAL REVIEW 2026

BOSTON COLLEGE • EXECUTIVE ED.D. IN HIGHER EDUCATION

Scholarship in Public

From faculty burnout to AI, scholar-leaders turn urgent questions into arguments others can use.

Towards the Greater

Provost, dean, and vice president appointments give judgment a wider field of consequence.

After the Defense

Defenses, residencies, coaching, and retreat carry formation past graduation.

The Long Work of Leading Well

Higher education needs leaders who
are strategic, future-focused, and for others.

FROM THE PROGRAM DIRECTOR

The Long Work of Leading Well

STATE OF THE PROGRAM

Some of you already know part of this story. For others, this will be new.

In mid- to late May, after nine years of treatment for sarcoma that included intensive radiation, my sister was diagnosed with an aggressive form of blood cancer. She needed a transplant. Several possible donors were tested. I was a perfect match on every measure the transplant team used, including stem cells and T cells.

I spent two weeks in Houston at MD Anderson to donate. The collection produced twice the transplant team's target. Her transplant was successful and, as I write this, she is cancer-free.

*“Do the right thing.
Always.”*

Jim Ryan, University of
Virginia valediction

Cohort 5 sent gifts and messages. Many students and alumni wrote letters. Luke brought paper copies to my house in late June. I am used to offering care in this community. Receiving it so generously was humbling, and I am grateful beyond what I can say here.

A little more than a week before I learned I would be the donor, my son graduated from the University of Virginia. At Valedictory Exercises, President Emeritus Jim Ryan gave the class four words: “Do the right thing. Always.” I did not know how soon they would apply to me.

Leadership shows in acts like these: colleagues who take on work you cannot do, a cohort that sends gifts, people who write letters. This year many of you made that visible to me.

Alison and I are also, at last, in the home we have been building for almost four years, and we will welcome alumni there during the Annual Fall Retreat.

Our collective work

Care in this community runs both ways. The people we teach and advise also teach and sustain us.

Across six cohorts, the Executive Ed.D. community now includes 89 students and alumni from more than 15 countries and regions across Africa, Asia, Europe, North America, South America, the Middle East, and Australia. They work at research universities, liberal arts colleges, art and design schools,

theological institutions, community colleges, and law schools, as presidents, provosts, vice presidents, deans, directors, faculty members, and senior staff. Our community's research runs across nine connected fields:

- international higher education and global mobility;
- first-generation access and student success;
- institutional governance, leadership, and transformation;
- enrollment strategy and institutional finance;
- equity, diversity, and BIPOC leadership;
- faculty and academic workforce development;
- technology, AI, and digital innovation;
- policy, credentials, and workforce alignment; and
- health professions and student well-being.

The issues overlap. Questions of technology are questions of human agency; questions of finance are questions of mission and access.

This year Cohort 3 defended and graduated, Cohort 6 brought new senior leaders into the program, and the community met at Boston College, in Santiago, and at Connors. Alumni grew through an executive dialogue, three rounds of group coaching, planning for new roundtables, and returns to program events, with the October retreat ahead. We also welcomed Jessica Belue Buckley to Boston College as Associate Professor of Higher Education; she teaches Foundations of Social Justice in Higher Education this fall.

The long work of leading well

This issue takes its theme from the phrase that now organizes much of my thinking: the long work of leading well. Higher education is under pressure to answer fast, to demographic decline, funding cuts, political scrutiny, and artificial intelligence, and answers made at that speed tend to serve the next quarter. The leadership this moment needs is strategic, future-focused, and for others: it reads the structure beneath the headline, thinks in decades rather than semesters, and takes its bearings from the students, faculty, and communities an institution exists to serve. It is formed over years, in relationships, and it holds up only if it is renewed.

The students and alumni in these pages are leaders of that kind. They drafted state regulations, took up provostships and vice presidencies, opened routes for students who had none, and kept public records that institutions need. They did this work while advising one another, returning for residencies and coaching, and writing letters to a director who needed them. That is the long work, and it is the reason a community like this one exists.





Who
should
join us
next?

We are admitting the next cohort for summer 2027. The strongest members of this community found us through people they trust. Think of an experienced higher education leader whose questions would deepen our conversations and whose judgment you respect. Introduce us, or invite them to write to me directly. They are welcome to join one of the fall information sessions, or to skip it and simply email me.

The application deadline is **December 1, 2026**. [Program information and application details are here.](#)



**contemporáneo, de los
profesionales,**

is Kauachi

ión de Internacionalización

01

Scholarship in Public

Practitioner-scholars turn urgent questions about equity, policy, technology, and mobility into arguments the public can test and use.

Faculty are asked to teach, publish, advise, serve on committees, and carry their institutions through every crisis, and much of that work goes unrecorded. Addrain Conyers (C3), who became Interim Provost and Dean of the Faculty at Marist University on July 1, 2026, has spent his doctoral research on what the gap does to people. This summer, *Innovative Higher Education* accepted “[The Contributions–Impact Model of Faculty Burnout](#),” drawn from his dissertation; it appeared open access on September 4. The model separates what faculty contribute from the impact of that work and from the recognition it earns, and it gives a provost, as much as a researcher, a way to see where the three come apart.

Others in the program put questions about equity, admissions, artificial intelligence, labor-market data, and the flow of students from China into print, onto panels, and in front of policymakers.

Seminar papers that went to press

Eve Famutimi (C4) wrote a paper for Raquel Muñiz’s course; it became a chapter in a 2026 Oxford University Press volume, written with Tara B. Blackshear, on [the “burden of service” that keeps Black women from tenure](#). Lisa Neary (C6) took the same course and workshopped a paper on the U.S. Department of Education’s RISE final rule across the term. In September *The Regulatory Review* accepted it. “Reforming the Reform” is her first publication.

Shane Dunn (C5) went a third way, writing with Muñiz and Andrés Castro Samayoa for Brookings in December 2025 on [what the Skrmetti decision means for transgender students and for the research that follows them](#).

From the Chronicle to the Department of Labor

Amy Tiberio (C2) spent the year writing for practitioners. Her four-part series on equity in admission ended in May with [“The Infrastructure of Equity: Data, Accountability, and the Work of Change,”](#) which argues that good intentions change

nothing until an institution decides who collects the data, who answers for it, and how anyone would know whether the numbers moved. In September *The Chronicle of Higher Education* interviewed her for [“How Texas Became an Enrollment Battleground”](#): colleges win a region through years of relationships with school and independent counselors, and lose it every time a recruiter quits.

Peter Rojas (C5), Director of the Intercultural Center at Brandeis University, published [“Juntos con Bad Bunny: We Are Pan-Americanism”](#) in *The EduLedger* in February and then sat for the Conversation Café episode [“Preparing Leaders for Systems Not Built for Them.”](#) His point in both: a seat at the table is not the same as the power to change what the table decides. Dana Brandt (C6) took a narrower question to the U.S. Department of Labor’s *Navigating the Skills Frontier* summit, which opened on June 9. When does a workforce system need fine-grained skills data, and when will a job title do? It depends, she argued, on the decision the data will be asked to make.

Mark Green (C2) spoke at EDUCAUSE and at Ai4 2026, then wrote [a reflection on classroom](#)

governance, access to AI learning, and institutional capacity. Mark Khan (C4) joined ASHE’s new Scholar-Practitioner Network. Luis Kauachi (C2) moderated [the closing plenary at CAEI 2025](#) on internationalization. Lorien Romito (C4) led [a session at IVEC](#) asking whether virtual exchange widens intercultural learning or quietly reproduces the inequalities it was meant to fix. In April, JB Anyeh, SJ (C3) wrote [on solidarity across the Jesuit Conference of Africa and](#)

[Madagascar](#). And *International Higher Education* will publish Xiaofeng Wan (C1)’s “The China Pipeline Is Closing, and American Colleges Aren’t Ready” later this year.



Peter Rojas (C5), Director of the Intercultural Center at Brandeis University.

Courtesy of Dana Brandt





Courtesy of Ashana Hurd

02 Leading Change

Leaders make values durable through regulation, educational pathways, public memory, and institutional practice.

Massachusetts now lets a college try a three-year bachelor's degree, on conditions. Kristen Stone (C1), working with the Department of Higher Education's legal and academic affairs teams, co-drafted 610 CMR 16.00, the regulation the Board of Higher Education adopted on February 10, 2026 to govern pilot proposals on innovation. A college may test a new model; in return the program must be called an applied bachelor's degree, students must sign a disclosure acknowledging its pilot status, and the institution must report to the Board every year. On June 26 the Board approved the first two pilots: 96-credit applied bachelor's degrees in business administration, communications, criminal justice, and psychology at Merrimack College, and a 94-credit applied bachelor's degree in healthcare administration and innovation at Suffolk University, both starting in fall 2027.

A rule is one way a value becomes something other people can use and be held to. Partnerships, archives, and strategy are others.

Leading for impact

Ashana Hurd (C2) announced the expansion of the Donovan Urban Teaching Scholars partnership to Brockton High School, a pathway into teaching that now rests on an arrangement between institutions rather than on one person's goodwill. Anya Villatoro Lorenz (C3) writes on persistence among first-generation and low-income students: admission is the first test, and belonging decides whether they stay. Taylor Delhagen (C1) writes about hospitality as something an institution designs rather than something it hopes for.

Florida State University Libraries chose a new digital archive in March and in June took in rare records from the Emmett Till trial. Katie McCormick (C6) served as interim dean during part of that period and continues as associate dean for Special Collections and Archives.

Olga Nazaykinskaya (C2) published research on what transformational leaders leave unsaid, graduated the 25th cohort of the Rectors' School, and in July ran a strategy-alignment session.

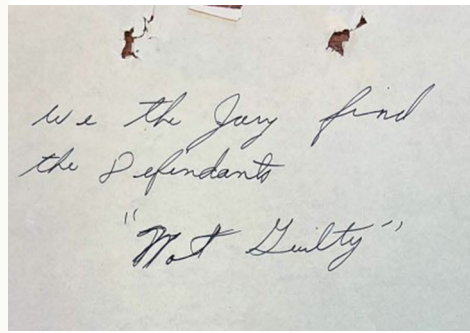
International perspectives

Laura S. Abreu Malla (C1) is moving her education-policy work in the Dominican Republic from national reports to what she calls "from data to territory": regional reports paired with local dialogues among civil-society organizations and other education stakeholders, so that the people a report describes can argue over it. This fall she

teaches Educational Policy Management, online with a mix of live and asynchronous sessions, to the first cohort of a new doctoral program in Education at a leading public teacher-education institution there. Arevik



Ohanyan (C4) is designing the curriculum for one of Armenia's first bachelor's degrees in artificial intelligence, developed with the Ministry of Education and FAST Foundation and built to run from secondary school through university to graduate study.



A record from the Emmett Till trial, acquired by FSU Libraries in 2026.

COURTESY OF FLORIDA STATE UNIVERSITY LIBRARIES

Mary Immaculate College's International Office won two 2026 Education Awards, for the MIC/CAPES Programme and for international engagement, under Holly Cowman (C1)'s leadership; the award photograph shows a team, which is what a reciprocal partnership takes. Mauricio López Oropeza (C4)'s membership in the Vatican's Dicastery for Promoting Integral Human Development was renewed, a responsibility tied to the Amazon University Program and to Amazonian communities. César Muziotti, SJ (C4) has put education to work in Venezuela's civic effort at reconciliation, forgiveness, healing, and memory.

A regulation can become compliance without learning; a partnership, branding without reciprocity; an archive, a collection nobody can reach. Each structure here was built with co-drafters, boards, partner schools, archivists, and communities, and each will hold only as long as someone stays answerable for it. Once a commitment is durable enough that others can act through it, the question changes: who will be responsible for what the institution has built?



Mary Immaculate College's International Office at the 2026 Education Awards.

COURTESY OF MARY IMMACULATE COLLEGE

03

Towards the Greater

Appointments in academic, mission, enrollment, and operational leadership give judgment a wider field of consequence.



On July 1, 2026, Addrain Conyers (C3) became Interim Provost and Dean of the Faculty at Marist University and Keith Maczkiewicz, SJ (C1) became Vice President for Mission and Chief Mission Officer at the College of the Holy Cross. One now sets the conditions of academic life for a faculty; the other has to make a Jesuit mission show up in hiring and budget decisions and not only in the mission statement. A larger title enlarges the reach of one person's judgment across faculty lives, student opportunities, budgets, and purpose.

A provost, a mission officer, an interim dean

Conyers arrives with his burnout model in print. A provost sets workloads, service expectations, and what counts at promotion, which is where the gap his research measures is made or closed. Maczkiewicz's office exists for the moments when priorities compete, so that a community can defend its choices in its own language. Luci Ramos Hoppe (C2) became interim dean of Baylor University's Diana R. Garland School of Social Work on October 15, 2025, holding a school steady through a transition without pretending that nothing is changing. César Muziotti, SJ (C4) has been organizing a TECHO Chile effort to bring some 500 student volunteers to build 200 homes in an earthquake-struck area.

Deciding who gets in

Joseph Dacey (C1) is Wentworth Institute of Technology's Senior Vice President of Strategy, Planning, and Enrollment, three functions that institutions run separately and students meet as one. Katie Gillette (C2) became Vice President for Enrollment Management and Assistant Professor of Catholic Education at the Augustine Institute over the summer, recruiting for the school and

teaching in it. Amy Tiberio (C2) left Roger Williams University in July to become Director of Enrollment at Dana Hall School, where her writing on equity in admission now meets an enrollment plan for a girls' school. Allyson Brown (C1) was promoted in March to Assistant Director for South Carolina Recruitment at the University of South Carolina, after a career across admissions, recruitment, student affairs, and equity work.

Promoted before the degree is done

Francisco Urrutia (C5) is ITESO's founding Coordinator of Development and Fundraising, a new office built around solidarity and support. Daniel Castillo Mauna (C6) became Director of Internationalization at Universidad Alberto Hurtado. Jason Oualline (C6) was named Dean of Academic Affairs at Laguna College of Art and Design in August. Lyubov "Luba" Niemann (C5) became Director of Finance and Administration for Brown University's Division of Master's and Professional Programs. All four are still in the program.

Budgets decide what survives. International strategy decides which relationships cross borders. Academic administration decides what faculty and students can do on a given Tuesday. None of these offices guarantees good judgment, and each can pull a leader away from the people its decisions touch. What every new seat does offer is a new view of whose flourishing is at stake, and the obligation to keep those people in sight.



04

After the Defense

Defenses, residencies, alumni returns, coaching, and retreat carry formation beyond graduation.

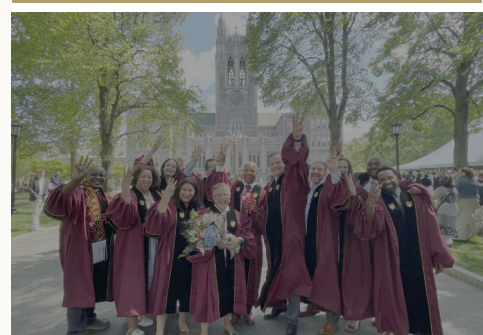
In spring 2026, thirteen members of Cohort 3 defended their dissertations and became alumni. Each defense had one name on the title page and three years of other people's questions behind it.

Whether formation continues once the timetable ends is a test of the program as much as of the graduate. Cohort relationships, residencies, alumni returns, coaching, roundtables, and retreat are the infrastructure for it.

Successful defenses and a celebratory commencement

Cohort 3: Carly Anderson (C3), Addrain Conyers (C3), Alexis Hamilton Fulks (C3), Nick Geremia (C3), Thomas Gutto (C3), Michael Harris (C3), Mara Hermano (C3), Claire Johnson Allen (C3), Cornell LeSane (C3), Joey Preston (C3), Anya Villatoro Lorenz (C3), and JB Anyeh, SJ (C3) celebrated successful defenses and graduation.

Carly Anderson (C3) wrote about the day. Cornell LeSane (C3) posted from his defense and came back to Connors in July. Anya Villatoro Lorenz (C3) graduated in May and by July was on the alumni panel, bringing her work on student success back to students who could use it. Luis Kauachi (C2) finished by a different route and walked at commencement on May 18, 2026. The Last Letter videos hold each graduate's own account of who they were becoming at the threshold, and no two say the same thing.



Cohort 3 at Boston College commencement on May 18, 2026.

Boston College, Santiago, Connors

Cohort 6 entered as Cohort 3 left. In between, the community met at Boston College in early June, in Santiago the following week, and at Connors in July. At Boston College, students worked in the program's academic home. Santiago set higher-education questions inside another country's politics and culture. At Connors, Cohort 4 worked a design challenge on live institutional problems, with alumni in the room as participants rather than visiting experts.

Mauricio López Oropeza (C4) visited Carroll College, spoke in Helena parishes, and gave the keynote at the college's student research festival; his hosts are still drawing on the talk as they plan next year's.

Coaching, roundtables, and a retreat on Glen Echo Pond

Claire Ostrander (C1), Special Assistant to the Vice President for Strategic Initiatives at Boston College, co-led the alumni engagement and development program with Alex Vasquez, so that alumni helped design the practices they would be invited into. Coaching gives one person confidential, accompanied reflection. Roundtables put alumni to work together on live institutional questions. Last fall, Michael Lochhead (C1) led an alumni roundtable on strategic budget management. This year, we will host a roundtable that places *Magnificas Humanitas* in dialogue with leadership choices related to artificial intelligence. The Fall Retreat this year will be October 23-25, 2026, including outdoor activities, small group gathering, and conversations at Chris' new home on Glen Echo Pond.